

The Morning Newspaper

FRIDAY, OCTOBER 2, 2026 · AUSTIN EDITION

78° / 73°

Rain, 55% chance, wind up to 6 mph

Tomorrow: 76° / 71°, light rain

Sunrise 7:25 · Sunset 19:15

 Waning gibbous

Wall Street rallies as a cooling jobs market eases rate-hike fears

A soft September payrolls report pulled bond yields down and sent the S&P 500 toward its best week in months, lifting nearly every index, crypto and stock on today's board and giving investors room to hope the Fed is done raising rates for now.

WORLD & TECH

Washington sends a third carrier group toward Iran

NPR · WIRE REPORTS

The U.S. is moving a third aircraft carrier into the region amid rising tension with Iran, a buildup that signals Washington wants more military options on hand without yet declaring a specific trigger. The move comes as President Trump launches a midterms campaign blitz amid record-low approval ratings, and as he separately floated asking European allies to release diesel reserves to ease fuel-price pressure at home.

Bitget confirms \$388 million hack

CNBC

The crypto exchange Bitget disclosed a \$388 million breach, one of the largest of the year and a reminder that exchange security hasn't kept pace with the money flowing through it. Its CEO told CNBC the company is "not expecting to recover a lot" of the stolen funds, even as investigators try to trace where it went.

SpaceX docks fastest crewed flight in U.S. history

NASA · WIRE REPORTS

SpaceX's Crew-13 astronauts reached the International Space Station less than eight hours after launch, the quickest American crewed trip to

orbit on record and a sign of how routine fast rendezvous profiles have become. The mission adds four more crew to the station's current rotation, continuing NASA's steady cadence of commercial crew flights this year.

MARKETS

INDEX	LAST	CHG
S&P 500	7,740.72	+0.97%
Dow Jones	51,220.93	+0.58%
Nasdaq	27,303.37	+1.61%
Russell 2000	2,844.99	+1.37%
VIX	15.61	-4.76%
10-yr yield	5.21	-0.54%

CRYPTO

Bitcoin	\$86,586	+3.27%
Ethereum	\$2,740.38	+1.84%

STOCKS

NVDA	\$236.55	+2.46%
AAPL	\$333.80	+1.05%
MSFT	\$517.92	+1.00%
GOOGL	\$344.40	+1.82%
AMZN	\$252.53	+1.73%
META	\$734.30	+1.15%
AVGO	\$354.31	+3.10%
TSLA	\$372.11	+5.08%
SPCX	\$157.01	+6.04%
BRK-B	\$502.10	+0.32%
TSM	\$469.53	+2.25%

Stocks rose across the board after a weak September jobs report suggested the labor market is cooling faster than expected, easing pressure on the Federal Reserve to keep rates high through year-end. Treasury yields fell on bets that a hike is now off the table, and a drop in oil prices below \$100 a barrel further calmed inflation worries. Accenture jumped on strong quarterly earnings and McKesson gained after reaffirming its fiscal 2027 guidance, helping broaden Friday's rally beyond the usual chipmakers and megacaps and into the broader market.

ON THIS DAY

On Oct. 2, 1869, Mohandas Gandhi was born in Porbandar, India. The United Nations now marks the date as the International Day of Non-Violence, and this week Saturn reaches opposition, its closest and brightest point of the year, visible in the southeast sky after dark.

FROM THE FEEDS · FULL TEXT IN SECTION B

LONGREADS

What It Feels Like at Cornell Right Now — a firsthand account inside a campus lawsuit over misogyny that's drawing national notice.

LONGREADS

The Work — a year embedded in independent pro wrestling, where only the outcome is scripted.

NAUTILUS

Where Did the "Social Magic" Go? — a sociologist on why more digital connection can mean more loneliness.

ASTRAL CODEX TEN

Our AI Midwife — a guest essay on trusting a chatbot during childbirth.

AEON

Life on a Hair Trigger — how growing up around violence rewires the mind, and how it can heal.

TRICYCLE

Parenting Is Not My Dharma Practice (and Maybe That's Okay) — making peace with practice that doesn't look like practice.

NAUTILUS

A Look at How Many Cancers Are Caused by Infections Worldwide — nearly one in eight trace back to a pathogen.

LONGREADS

What It Feels Like at Cornell Right Now

CAROLYN WELLS · LONGREADS.COM · OCT 2, 2026

A firsthand account of a campus lawsuit over misogyny and safety that's drawing national attention.

Kate Manne, a philosophy professor at Cornell University, situates the lawsuit from a former student alleging she was gang-raped at the Chi Phi fraternity in 2024 within a broader, deeply troubling campus “rape culture.” The specific details of Jane Doe’s case are horrific, but Manne also points to shocking statistics and examples showing that sexual misconduct is rife and often taken less seriously than other student infractions. She is critical of Cornell’s response and culture, but emphasizes that, tragically, this normalization of misogyny is widespread across many American campuses. A disturbing, important read.

In a deeply misogynistic society, groups of boys and men routinely bond over humiliating and exploiting women, as Soraya Chemaly has

written. And the victim is not only physically and emotionally traumatized following one of the most fundamental imaginable violations: They are likely to be doubted and undermined at every subsequent step of the process. In Jane Doe’s case, the district attorney did not bring any charges after relying on the investigation done by campus police; they didn’t even speak with the men involved. The district attorney just announced that they are reopening the case on the basis of new information contained in the civil lawsuit, and in recognition of the fact that “it can take years of therapy and healing for victims of sexual assaults to fully process and understand what happened to them.”

LONGREADS

The Work

BRENDAN FITZGERALD · LONGREADS.COM · OCT 1, 2026

A year embedded in the independent pro-wrestling circuit, where only the outcome is scripted.

“Who wouldn’t decide to be their most expansive and radiant self?” Ah, but would you pursue that self through a sheet of tempered glass? In this literal tour de force, Katherine Cusumano shadows wrestlers navigating the independent promoters of the Pacific Northwest, granting sensational access to the lives and ambitions behind elaborate personas you’ve never heard of and will almost certainly search YouTube for. Cusumano is note-perfect on the details, taking obvious delight in the gimmicks of each wrestler’s beloved character and relishing the complexity of the choreography, rehearsed in elaborate code. (“Clothesline, crossbody in the corner, clothesline, Superman, Superman, I’m fired up, whoop, sliced bread, Ricky catches, oh shit, real fast.”) Spectacle abounds, but Cusumano rises above it, way up on the turnbuckle, with a heartening consideration of how we understand our own stories, and what we devote to realizing them.

I found myself drawn to this world, to its freakish feats of acrobatics, to its relentless and obsessive blurring of the boundary between reality and story, and, more than anything, to the supreme, sometimes monastic devotion of its competitors. I had been trying for ages to understand competition, ambition, the scaffolding that holds up good-bad, win-lose, and wrestling confounded these binaries. I started talking to Drex1, an old-timer with one foot out the door of his career, who eventually referred me to Amira, an emerging wrestler with an already impressive résumé, and I thought that was so like wrestling, to proffer such perfect narrative symmetry. They agreed—more readily than I’d expected, given how fiercely professional wrestlers have historically protected the secrets of their work—to let me follow them around. Which is how I ended up behind the curtain.

A few more stunners from the ring



Continued online (full article about 367 words). Scan, or visit <https://longreads.com/2026/10/01/independent-wrestling-pacific-northwest/>

NAUTILUS

Where Did the "Social Magic" Go?

KRISTEN FRENCH · NAUTIL.US · OCT 1, 2026

An Icelandic sociologist on why digital connection leaves people feeling more alone.

Our digital age presents a paradox, says Icelandic sociologist Vidar Halldorsson. Though humans are more connected and accessible to one another in a global and immediate way, our ability to actually bond with one another using all of the senses is

eroding. With our handheld supercomputers at the ready, we are less connected to one another in the end, not more.

This is not a new idea, but Halldorsson has coined a new term he calls “social magic,” the tiny signals and exchanges of energy and empathetic connection that come from being in a physical space with another human being and which help to build a society. Facial micro-expressions, body language, spatial proximity, and even smell all carry social information, he says. French sociologist and father of social science Émile Durkheim might have called this “collective effervescence,” the sense of being part of something larger than oneself.

Halldorsson hangs responsibility for the loneliness, polarization, anxiety, and hate of our current era in large part on how screens have come to dominate every facet of daily life. So many activities we

used to do in physical spaces with others are now available at the press of a button from home: grocery shopping, taking in a movie, sports watching, even religious practice.

Halldorsson recently published a new book, *How Digital Screen Use Alienates Human Societies: A Treatise on Social Magic and its Decadence*. In it he argues that we need to bring back social magic. I spoke with him about team sports, human adaptation, and how we might revive cultures of collectivism.

Much of your research has focused on the psychology of athletes and team sports. Do you see any direct relationship between that work and the subject of your new book, screens and loneliness?



Continued online (full article about 1968 words). Scan, or visit <https://nautil.us/where-did-the-social-magic-go-1285451/>

ASTRAL CODEX TEN

Our AI Midwife

SCOTT ALEXANDER · ASTRALCODEXTEN.COM · OCT 2, 2026

A guest essay on trusting a chatbot with decisions during childbirth.

This is a guest post by Drew Housman, whose review of *Dominion* earned finalist status in the 2024 ACX book review contest.

If you are unsuccessful for long enough on your pregnancy journey, and none of the many doctors you see can identify a problem, you get branded with a label. You now have “unexplained infertility.” This is good because there’s still hope of fixing the problem but dreaded because once you’ve reached this point the system is less interested in you. The fertility doctors don’t become unkind, but they also don’t give you the sense they are poring over medical journals trying to figure out your problem. They have looked for the keys under the streetlight and come up empty. Once you have unexplained infertility, the doctors start saying things like, “Have you considered using a

surrogate?” and, “Sure, the last 5 embryo transfers failed, but what if we try a 6th and cross our fingers really hard?”

My wife and I could make healthy embryos, but none of the transfers were sticking. It was so frustrating to be able to create life only to have it trapped forever in a cooler at a hospital in Milwaukee, our babies like so many forgotten Miller Lights.

That’s when our LLM doctor stepped in.

The Famous Actor in our Pocket

Even if you’re paying a gazillion dollars for IVF treatments, you still only get a few precious moments to talk to your doctor every visit. That’s just how the US medical system works. If you want to plumb the depths of what treatments are possible, or ask super detailed and anxiety ridden questions about every single scan from the latest round of imaging, you’re going to want a chatbot by your side.



Continued online (full article about 1549 words). Scan, or visit <https://www.astralcodexten.com/p/our-ai-midwife>